

Accolite

It consists of 5 rounds.

Round 1: Aptitude round

There were aptitude questions based on Operating Systems, Computer Networks, Database Management Systems, Quantitative Aptitude, Logical reasoning. A mix up of all these aptitudes rounding to 30 questions. This test was held on EduThrill platform and the total time given was around 30-40 minutes. You really need to be very quick in solving those quantitative aptitude which will boost your time to analyze the technical aptitude questions. Most of the students except a few were selected for the next coding round. You need to answer a reasonably correct number of questions to get selected to the next round.

Round 2: Coding round

In this round, 2 coding questions were asked and both of them were very easy ones. With a little bit of practice one could solve them both in 5-10 minutes. I would highly recommend to practice coding in Hackerrank platform for beginners and Geeks for geeks and Code-chef platform for intermediates and advanced level coders. Try completing the must do interview questions available in Geeks for geeks well ahead of the placement season. The below are the questions asked

1. Trapping rain water

(<https://www.geeksforgeeks.org/trapping-rain-water/>)

2. Happy arrays

(<https://codechef.com/problems/HAPPYARR> (Not a same question but similar to this))

Mainly the Coding round was fully focused on solving real time problems and it was held on Codelyzer platform. Candidates can use any language of their choice for solving the coding questions. Since the questions were easy many were able to solve them both, hence the selection criteria were based on space and time complexity and also the time taken by the candidate to solve the problems. The candidates selected for the face to face interviews were announced 2 hours post the coding round. Around 80 were shortlisted for the next round. All the face to face interviews were held over skype.

Round 3: Technical interview

The interview began with formal greetings. She then asked me to introduce myself and had a casual talk with me to make me feel comfortable. The following questions were asked

1. The task is to divide an array into K non-empty subsets such that the sum of elements in every subset is same. All elements of this array should be part of exactly one partition.
2. The task is to find if there is a triplet in an array whose sum is equal to the given value.
3. The task is to split the given array into K subarrays (they must cover all the elements). The maximum subarray sum achievable out of K subarrays formed, must be minimum possible. Find that possible subarray sum.
4. She then tested my knowledge on binary trees by asking about the different kind of traversals like inorder, postorder, preorder, level order and asked me the difference between them with an example.

The below are some links which will help you to solve those questions.

<https://www.geeksforgeeks.org/partition-set-k-subsets-equal-sum/>

<https://www.geeksforgeeks.org/split-the-given-array-into-k-sub-arrays-such-that-maximum-sum-of-all-sub-arrays-is-minimum/>

<https://www.geeksforgeeks.org/find-a-triplet-that-sum-to-a-given-value/>

<https://www.geeksforgeeks.org/tree-traversals-inorder-preorder-and-postorder/>

WHAT I SUGGEST TO YOU FROM THIS ROUND :

- Give a strong introduction about yourself since that is the first impression about you to the interviewer.
- Take some time to analyze the problem. Break the entire problems into sub problems and try solving the sub problems to arrive at your answers.

- Discuss your approach with your interviewer and make them involved in your approach.
- Try cracking those corner cases first to impress your interviewer.

Many were unable to crack this round due to its level of hardness but luckily I was on the other side. The next interview was held after 15 minutes post completion of this round.

Round 4: Technical interview

The interviewer asked me to introduce myself and I was asked questions on my resume. We had a long chat on my summer research intern project and then the interview began.

1. Given a Binary Tree, convert it to a Doubly Linked List. The left and right pointers in nodes are to be used as previous and next pointers respectively in converted DLL. The order of nodes in DLL must be same as inorder of the given Binary Tree. The first node of inorder traversal (left most node in BT) must be head node of the DLL.

Note: To be very honest, I became nervous on seeing this question but I didn't give up and started to suggest some approaches. The interviewer then found that I was not so comfortable with this question and gave me another question.

2. Find Maximum Length of a sub-string without any repetitions.
 - For "ABDEFGABEF", the longest substring are "BDEFGA" and "DEFGAB", with length 6.
 - For "BBBB" the longest substring is "B", with length 1.
3. Given a string s1 and a string s2, write a snippet to say whether s2 is a rotation of s1?
(eg given s1 = ABCD and s2 = CDAB, return true, given s1 = ABCD, and s2 = ACBD , return false)
4. Reverse a linked list in groups of given sizes
5. A puzzle to test my problem solving capability

<https://www.geeksforgeeks.org/puzzle-1000-light-bulbs-switched-on-off-by-1000-persons-passing-by/> (not the exact one but with some modification in the numbers)

WHAT I SUGGEST TO YOU FROM THIS ROUND :

- Be honest with the interviewer if you are asked whether you find it difficult or not , be honest with him but suggest some approaches to express your “never give up” attitude.
- Always try to optimize your solutions if you are asked to. Have good knowledge of the time and space complexities.
- Practice a lot of puzzles and riddles as solving them show off your problem solving skills.
- Always discuss your approach with the interviewer as he/she may give some hints to optimize your approach, never keep your interviewer idle.

At the end of this round, the interviewer was very much impressed with my performance and he connected the call to his manager immediately for my HR round.

Round 5: HR interview

The manager asked me to introduce myself and started testing my communication and thinking out-the-box skills. He asked me about the Covid-19 impact on Tamil Nadu and questioned me on the effectiveness of the measures taken by the Government during this pandemic and also asked me to suggest some measures if I were given the authority. Then we had a chat about Indian railways giving free Wifi access to its passengers (good/bad/what else could be done), climate in my area of residence and so on.

Later he questioned me on aptitudes regarding Distance/Speed and Time/Clocks. He even gave me two problems to solve on finding the angle between minute and hour hand. Later he was very satisfied and appreciated me for my performance.

Finally 11 of them were selected and I got my name on that list. :)

WHAT I SUGGEST TO YOU FROM THIS ROUND :

- Be prepared with quantitative aptitudes as it can even help you in your HR round as it did in my case. I would suggest websites like Indiabix, Freshers world etc.
- Even though I was not asked any formal HR questions like 1. Why should I hire you? 2.What are your strengths and weakness , be prepared to answer them as well as banking and investment sectors which are on for placements would ask them for sure.

Topics to be focused:

1. Data structures & Algorithms.
2. Competitive coding/Problem solving.
3. Object Oriented Programming Language for implementation in the interview.
(C++/JAVA is mostly preferred by the interviewers)
4. Projects mentioned in your resume.
5. Aptitude (Verbal/Reasoning/Quantitative)
6. Communication (Be prepared with your answers for famous HR questions)

ALL THE BEST!!!

For any further assistance or more details contact me on my mail id.

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